



CLEAN UP ACT

WITH AN electorate waiting to be wooed, political parties have begun washing their election linen, sometimes even in public. Workers in Ahmedabad wheel out a barrel-full of Congress flags in preparation for the polls that will be unfurled in all their tumultuous colour and clamour next month.

DELHI | Forbidden Fruit

With elections round the corner and an anticipated rise in forcible pick-up of vehicles—especially suvs—for campaigning, the police have stepped up their vigil on car-lifting gangs in Bihar and Haryana. However, this time the police were at their wits end over intercepted messages ordering local goons to pick up 40 ‘angoors’ (grapes) and some ‘papitas’ (papaya). Bewildered, the force carried out some brisk enquiries which revealed that gangs desperate to throw off the police from their tracks have hit upon codewords for vehicles to convey their preferences as per the requirements of poll candidates. Small cars like the Maruti Alto are called *angoor* while the reigning favourites, the fancier ones like Pajero, Montero and Outlanders, go by the name of *papita*.

by Nivedita Mukherjee



ANGOOR AND PAPITA ARE SOME OF THE CODENAMES FOR CARS THAT VEHICLE THIEVES ARE USING FOR THE POLLS.